Configuring URL Categories Using API

Predefined and custom URL categories provide a way to classify URLs for your organization. URL categories are primarily used in URL Filtering policy rules, and are useful when blocking or allowing web traffic. TLD categories are URL categories that allow you to group together top-level domains (TLDs). TLD categories are used in URL Filtering policies to control access to domains for a specific country, or to block access to TLDs that might be used solely for malicious purposes. You can configure and manage URL and TLD categories using the cloud service API. For detailed information about the API endpoints, see URL Categories in the API Reference.

You can easily manage custom URL category updates using the Bulk URL Upload tool. To learn more, see About Bulk URL Upload Tool.

The following sections explain the various operations that you can perform using URL Categories endpoints, along with examples.

> After making any configuration changes, ensure that you activate them by sending a POST request to `/status`.

Getting Information about URL and TLD Categories

To retrieve information for all predefined and custom URL categories, send a GET request to `/urlCategories`. For example, in Python:

```
conn.request("GET", "/api/v1/urlCategories", headers=headers)
```

Using the `customOnly` parameter, you can filter the information to retrieve only custom URL categories. For example:

```
conn.request("GET", "/api/v1/urlCategories?customOnly=true", headers=headers)
```

To retrieve information about TLD categories, send a GET request to `/urlCategories` with the `type` parameter set to `TLD_CATEGORY`. For example:

```
conn.request("GET", "/api/v1/urlCategories?type=TLD_CATEGORY", headers=headers)
```

If you only want a list of URL category IDs and names, send a GET request to `/urlCategories/lite` .

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Adding Custom URL and TLD Categories

To add a custom URL category:

Send a POST request to `/urlCategories` by including all of the proper key-value pairs in the Body. The following information is required: `configuredName`, `urls` or `keywords`, and `superCategory`. Optionally, you can specify other details, such as `dbCategorizedUrls`, `keywordsRetainingParentCategory`, etc. that are applicable to URL categories.

See an example request to add a custom URL category and its response.

In the following example, a POST request is sent to `/urlCategories` to add a new custom URL category:

```
import http.client
    import json
    conn = http.client.HTTPSConnection("HOSTNAME")
    payload = json.dumps({
      "configuredName": "Vlogs",
      "superCategory": "ENTERTAINMENT",
      "keywords": [
        "vlog"
      ],
      "urls": [
        "livejournal.com"
      ]
    })
    headers = {
      'Content-Type': 'application/json',
      'Cookie': 'JSESSIONID=xxxxxx'
    }
    conn.request("POST", "/api/v1/urlCategories", payload, headers)
    res = conn.getresponse()
    data = res.read()
    print(data.decode("utf-8"))
```

The response would look similar to the following example:

```
{
        "id": "CUSTOM_16",
        "configuredName": "Vlogs",
        "superCategory": "ENTERTAINMENT",
        "keywords": [
            "vlog"
        ],
        "keywordsRetainingParentCategory": [],
        "urls": [
            "livejournal.com"
```

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```
        ],
        "dbCategorizedUrls": [],
        "customCategory": true,
        "editable": true,
        "description": "CUSTOM_16_DESC",
        "type": "URL_CATEGORY",
        "val": 143,
        "customUrlsCount": 1,
        "urlsRetainingParentCategoryCount": 0,
        "customIpRangesCount": 0,
        "ipRangesRetainingParentCategoryCount": 0
    }
```

To add a custom TLD category:

Send a POST request to `/urlCategories` by including all of the proper key-value pairs in the Body. The following information is required: `type`, `configuredName`, `superCategory`, and `urls`. Optionally, you can specify `description` and `scopes` that are applicable to TLD categories.

See an example request to add a custom TLD category and its response.

In the following example, a POST request is sent to `/urlCategories` to add a new custom TLD category.

```
import http.client
    import json
    conn = http.client.HTTPSConnection("HOSTNAME")
    payload = json.dumps({
      "type": "TLD_CATEGORY",
      "configuredName": "Sample TLD Category",
      "superCategory": "USER_DEFINED",
      "urls": [
        ".academy"
      ],
      "scopes": [
        {
          "Type": "ORGANIZATION"
        },
        {
          "Type": "DEPARTMENT",
          "ScopeEntities": [
            {
              "id": 73965,
              "name": "Training"
            }
          ]
        }
```

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```
    ]
  })
  headers = {
    'Content-Type': 'application/json',
    'Cookie': 'JSESSIONID=xxxxxx'
  }
  conn.request("POST", "/api/v1/urlCategories", payload, headers)
  res = conn.getresponse()
  data = res.read()
  print(data.decode("utf-8"))
```

The response would look similar to the following example:


```
{
        "id": "CUSTOM_10",
        "configuredName": "Sample TLD Category",
        "superCategory": "USER_DEFINED",
        "keywords": [],
        "keywordsRetainingParentCategory": [],
        "urls": [
            ".academy"
        ],
        "dbCategorizedUrls": [],
        "customCategory": true,
        "scopes": [
            {
                "Type": "ORGANIZATION"
            },
            {
                "Type": "DEPARTMENT",
                "ScopeEntities": [
                    {
                        "id": 73965,
                        "name": "Training"
                    }
                ]
            }
        ],
        "editable": true,
        "description": "CUSTOM_10_DESC",
        "type": "TLD_CATEGORY",
        "val": 137,
        "customUrlsCount": 1,
        "urlsRetainingParentCategoryCount": 0,
        "customIpRangesCount": 0,
        "ipRangesRetainingParentCategoryCount": 0
    }
```


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If the admin scope `Type` is not specified within the request Body, then it is set to `ANY` by default and any admin can manage the custom URL category. To learn more, see the Understanding RBAC and Admin Scope for Custom URL Categories section of this article.

Understanding RBAC and Admin Scope for Custom URL Categories

With role-based administration, an admin's scope specifies which areas of the organization they can manage in the ZIA Admin Portal. To learn more, see About Admin Scope.

Using the cloud service API, you can retrieve the admin scope information for a custom URL category by sending a GET request to `/urlCategories?customOnly=true`. The admin scope is included in the response only if it's set to a `Type` other than `ANY` (i.e., ORGANIZATION, DEPARTMENT, LOCATION, LOCATION_GROUP).

See an example request with admin scope specified.

```
{
        "id": "CUSTOM_02",
        "configuredName": "demo",
        "superCategory": "USER_DEFINED",
        "urls": [
            "abc.com"
        ],
        "dbCategorizedUrls": [],
        "customCategory": true,
        "scopes": [
            {
                "Type": "ORGANIZATION"
            },
            {
                "Type": "DEPARTMENT",
                "ScopeEntities": [
                    {
                        "id": 363517,
                        "name": "Service Admin"
                    }
                ]
            }
        ],
        "editable": true,
        "val": 129
    }
```

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If `editable` is set to `true`, then admins with the proper admin scope are able to edit the custom URL category. An admin without this permission has read-only access.

> As a best practice, you should always send a GET request before a PUT request to `/urlCategories/{categoryId}`. This helps avoid potentially missing updates between GET and PUT calls as well as ensure that you do not accidentally overwrite the admin scope for an existing custom URL category.

Updating URL and TLD Categories

You can update URL categories (predefined or custom) and TLD categories by sending a PUT request to `/urlCategories/{categoryId}`. However, the attributes that you can modify using this request vary between URL and TLD categories.

To update a URL or TLD category:

1. (Optional) Get information about the category you want to modify by sending a GET request to `/urlCategories` or `/urlCategories/lite` with the right attributes set. To learn more, see the Getting Information About URL and TLD Categories. Sending a GET request before a PUT request to `/urlCategories/{categoryId}` helps avoid potentially missing updates between GET and PUT calls as well as ensure that you do not accidentally overwrite any information for an existing custom URL category.
2. Modify the category's information by sending a PUT request to `/urlCategories/{categoryId}` and including all of the proper key-value pairs in the Body.

   > When modifying custom URL categories, you must specify the `configuredName` and `superCategory` information in the request Body. These fields are not required for predefined URL categories. For custom TLD categories, `configuredName` is required.

The list of URLs, IP addresses, or TLDs passed in the PUT request replaces the current list in the category. If you want to add or remove URLs, IP addresses, or TLDs within a category, include the `action` parameter and specify the value as `ADD_TO_LIST` or `REMOVE_FROM_LIST`, as explained in the following sections.

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Zscaler recommends always using the `ADD_TO_LIST` and `REMOVE_TO_LIST` parameters as a best practice when adding or removing URLs, IP addresses, or TLDs from a category. Using these parameters with your PUT request ensures that you obtain the best response times for your API calls.

Adding and Removing URLs or IP Addresses within a URL Category

To add or remove a URL or an IP address from a category, send a PUT request to `/urlCategories/{categoryId}` with the `action` parameter set to `ADD_TO_LIST` or `REMOVE_FROM_LIST` and include all of the proper key-value pairs in the request Body. If you are modifying a custom URL category, this request must additionally specify the `configuredName` and `superCategory` information in the request Body.

See an example request to add URLs and IP addresses to a predefined URL category and its response.

In the following example, a PUT request is sent to `/urlCategories/MUSIC?action=ADD_TO_LIST` in order to add `sampletest5.com`, `192.168.1.1`, and `test5.com` to the predefined `MUSIC` category:

```
import http.client
    import json
    conn = http.client.HTTPSConnection("HOSTNAME")
    payload = {
    "superCategory": "ENTERTAINMENT_AND_RECREATION",
        "urls":[
            "sampletest5.com",
            "192.168.1.1"
        ],
        "dbCategorizedUrls":[
            "test5.com"
        ]
    }
    headers = {
        'content-type': "application/json",
        'cache-control': "no-cache",
        'cookie': "JSESSIONID=xxxxxxx"
        }
    conn.request("PUT", "/api/v1/urlCategories/MUSIC?action=ADD_TO_LIST", json.dumps(p
ayload), headers)
    res = conn.getresponse()
    data = res.read()
    print(data.decode("utf-8"))
```

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The response would look similar to the following example:

```
{
        "id": "MUSIC",
        "urls": [
            "sampletest5.com",
            "sampletest4.com",
            "192.168.1.1"
        ],
        "dbCategorizedUrls": [
            "test4.com",
            "test5.com"
        ],
        "customCategory": false,
        "editable": true,
        "description": "MUSIC_DESC",
        "val": 24
    }
```

You can add IPv6 addresses (e.g., 2041:0000:140f:0000:0000:0000:875b:131b or 2041:0000:140f::875b:131b) to a category.

See an example request to remove URLs and IP addresses from a custom URL category and its response.

In the following example, a PUT request is sent to `/urlCategories/CUSTOM_05?action=REMOVE_FROM_LIST` in order to remove `example.com` and `192.168.1.3` from the CUSTOM_05 category:

```
import http.client
    import json
    conn = http.client.HTTPSConnection("HOSTNAME")
    payload = json.dumps({
      "configuredName": "Popular Media",
      "superCategory":"NEWS_AND_MEDIA",
      "urls": [
        "example.com",
        "192.168.1.3"
      ]
    })
    headers = {
      'content-type': 'application/json',
      'cache-control': "no-cache",
      'cookie': 'JSESSIONID=xxxxxxx'
      }
    conn.request("PUT", "/api/v1/urlCategories/CUSTOM_05?action=REMOVE_FROM_LIST", pay
```

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```
load, headers)
    res = conn.getresponse()
    data = res.read()
    print(data.decode("utf-8"))
```

So, the response would look similar to the following example:

```
{
        "id": "CUSTOM_05",
        "configuredName": "Popular Media",
        "keywords": [],
        "keywordsRetainingParentCategory": [],
        "urls": [
            "192.168.1.2",
            "sample.com"
        ],
        "dbCategorizedUrls": [],
        "customCategory": true,
        "editable": true,
        "description": "CUSTOM_05_DESC",
        "type": "URL_CATEGORY",
        "val": 132,
        "customUrlsCount": 2,
        "urlsRetainingParentCategoryCount": 0,
        "customIpRangesCount": 0,
        "ipRangesRetainingParentCategoryCount": 0
    }
```

You can remove IPv6 addresses (e.g., 2041:0000:140f:0000:0000:0000:875b:131b or 2041:0000:140f::875b:131b) from a category.

- The `action` parameter is only applicable to URLs or IP addresses. If a category has any existing keywords, then the keywords must be sent in the request payload.
- When adding URLs to a URL category, if a single URL uses an invalid format, the request is rejected and produces an error code. A valid URL must meet the following requirements:
    - The URL must use a standard URI format.
    - The URL length cannot exceed 1024 characters.
    - The URL cannot contain non-ASCII characters.
    - The domain name before the colon (:) cannot exceed 255 characters.

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- The domain name between periods (.) cannot exceed 63 characters.

Adding and Removing Top-level Domains within a TLD Category

To add or remove TLDs from a custom TLD category, send a PUT request to `/urlCategories/{categoryId}` with the `action` parameter set to `ADD_TO_LIST` or `REMOVE_FROM_LIST` and include all of the proper key-value pairs in the request Body. You must also specify the `configuredName` information in the request Body.

See an example request to add TLDs to a TLD category and its response.

In the following example, a PUT request is sent to `/urlCategories/CUSTOM_10?action=ADD_TO_LIST` to add `.com` and `.net` to a TLD category:

```
import http.client
    import json
    conn = http.client.HTTPSConnection("HOSTNAME")
    payload = {
    "superCategory": "USER_DEFINED",
        "urls":[
            ".com", ".net"
        ],
    }
    headers = {
        'content-type': "application/json",
        'cache-control': "no-cache",
        'cookie': "JSESSIONID=xxxxxxx"
        }
    conn.request("PUT", "/api/v1/urlCategories/CUSTOM_10?action=ADD_TO_LIST", json.dum
ps(payload), headers)
    res = conn.getresponse()
    data = res.read()
    print(data.decode("utf-8"))
```

The response would look similar to the following example:

```
{
        "id": "CUSTOM_10",
        "configuredName": "Sample TLD Category",
        "superCategory": "USER_DEFINED",
        "keywords": [],
        "keywordsRetainingParentCategory": [],
        "urls": [
            ".academy", ".net", ".com"
        ],
        "dbCategorizedUrls": [],
        "customCategory": true,
```

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```
        "scopes": [
            {
                "Type": "ORGANIZATION"
            },
            {
                "Type": "DEPARTMENT",
                "ScopeEntities": [
                    {
                        "id": 73965,
                        "name": "Training"
                    }
                ]
            }
        ],
        "editable": true,
        "description": "CUSTOM_10_DESC",
        "type": "TLD_CATEGORY",
        "val": 137,
        "customUrlsCount": 3,
        "urlsRetainingParentCategoryCount": 0,
        "customIpRangesCount": 0,
        "ipRangesRetainingParentCategoryCount": 0
    }
```


Deleting Custom URL and TLD Categories

You can delete custom URL and TLD categories, but predefined URL categories cannot be deleted. If the custom category you are trying to delete is being used by a URL policy or NSS feed, the request fails.

To delete a custom URL or TLD category, send a DELETE request to `/urlCategories/{categoryId}`.

Looking Up the Category for a URL

To determine the categories to which a URL belongs, send a POST request to `/urlLookup` with the URLs in the request Body. You can look up to 100 URLs maximum per request, and a URL cannot exceed 1024 characters.

> Custom URL classification is not returned by this request. Any URLs that are not categorized under a predefined URL category returns a value of `MISCELLANEOUS_OR_UNKNOWN`.

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The `/urlLookup` endpoint returns a field called `SecurityAlert` whose possible values include, but are not limited to, the following:

- `OTHER_THREAT`
- `PHISHING`
- `BOTNET`
- `MALWARE_SITE`
- `P2P`
- `UNAUTHORIZED_COMMUNICATION`
- `XSS`
- `BROWSER_EXPLOIT`
- `SUSPICIOUS_DESTINATION`
- `SPYWARE_OR_ADWARE`
- `WEB_SPAM`
- `PAGE_RISK_INDEX`

You can download a complete URL category list, which includes all predefined URL classes, super categories, and categories: Download

To learn more, see About URL Categories.

Determining the Custom URL Quota

You can add up to 25K custom URLs (across all categories), and up to 64 custom categories. You can add up to 30 keywords per category, and up to 1,000 across all categories. To learn more, see Ranges & Limitations.

If you have reached the maximum number of custom URLs for your organization, you get the following `400` error code response when you try to add another URL:

```
An organization can have a maximum of 25000 custom URLs. Currently {Custom URL Quota} ar
e already provisioned for this organization.
```

For example:

```
An organization can have a maximum of 25000 custom URLs. Currently 1020 are already prov
isioned for this organization.
```

To avoid this message, check your organization's custom URL quota by sending a GET request to `/urlCategories/urlQuota`. The response includes how many unique URLs are already provisioned and how many URLs you can still create.

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